Ultimate Budget Spreadsheet: User Guide

File

Ultimate_Budget_Spreadsheet.xlsx (Excel 2019 or Microsoft 365). 28 tabs, no macros, demo data January to November 2026.

Getting started

- Open Easy Setup. Set currency, budget year, monthly spending budget and savings target.
- Edit categories (each has a group and a 50/30/20 class), payment methods, accounts and frequencies.
- Clear the demo entries in Variable Transactions and enter your own.

Recording money

- Variable Transactions is the ledger: one row per income or expense. Choose Type, Category and Account.
- Savings transfers: record as an expense from Checking with category Savings transfer. The Savings account balance adds them.
- Recurring Transactions shows next payment dates. It does not post entries; enter each occurrence in the ledger.
- Payments tracks bills, with overdue and due-soon alerts.

Dashboards

- All-in-One Dashboard: income, spending, net cash flow, savings, savings rate, budget, budget remaining, total debt, and charts.
- Annual Totals: month-by-month totals and budget variance.
- Automated Calendar: income, bills and savings by day.
- Paycheck Dashboard: gross, deductions, net and allocations per paycheck.

Monthly sheets

January to December: month summary, category totals, and that month's transactions (first 30).

Build your wealth

- 50/30/20: compares needs, wants and savings and debt with targets.
- Sinking Funds, Debt Calculator (choose Snowball or Avalanche), Net Worth, Investment Forecast (hypothetical only), and the No-Spending Challenge.

Definitions

- Spending excludes savings transfers. Net cash flow = income minus spending minus savings.
- Debt payoff dates and interest are estimates from the APR and payment entered.